Chapter 5
Print ISBN: 978-81-19761-93-7, eBook ISBN: 978-81-19761-62-3

Achieving Competitive Advantage through Strategic Positioning: Harvard Business Review Insights

Adisu Fanta Bate [a*]

DOI: 10.9734/bpi/aobmer/v4/6522C

Peer Review History:
This chapter was reviewed by following the Advanced Open Peer Review policy. This chapter was thoroughly checked to prevent plagiarism. As per editorial policy, a minimum of two peer-reviewers reviewed the manuscript. After review and revision of the manuscript, the Book Editor approved the manuscript for final publication. Peer review comments, comments of the editor(s), etc. are available here: https://peerreviewarchive.com/review-history/6522C

ABSTRACT

In relatively predictable markets, strategic positioning is crucial for a company's competitive advantage. Hence, understanding and establishing the basis for strategic positioning is essential, as seen in companies like IKEA furniture, Southwestern Airlines, and Neutrogena Corporation. However, operational effectiveness is still necessary for a company to maintain competitiveness. Investing in managerial capital is key to operational excellence, which leads to faster growth, higher profitability, and less likelihood of dissolution. To improve operational effectiveness, companies may use management tools like Kaizen and TQM, select the right supply chains, and extended services, and use the right mix of resources. Above all, positional strategy must be clearly distinguished from other functional strategies, such as innovation, manufacturing, and marketing, to achieve and sustain competitive advantage. This article further elucidates strategic positioning and its basis and sheds light on how to achieve and maintain a competitive advantage despite all the odds.

Keywords: Strategy; strategic positioning; competitive advantage.

1. INTRODUCTION

There have been diverse views on the means to attain competitive advantage and the debate among scholars remains open. Literature reveals a wide range of insights on the path to secure a competitive advantage i.e., a favorable or superior business position in terms of cost leadership or differentiation resulting in higher perceived customer value [1]. Companies may achieve competitive advantage over rivals through effective innovation strategies [2,3], controlling

[a] *University of Pecs, Hungary.*
**Corresponding author: E-mail: adisufanta@gmail.com;*

downstream marketing activities [4,5], and operational effectiveness by applying management tools like Kaizen and Just-in-Time (JIT) [28], downstream business models such as embedded, comprehensive service and integrative solutions [5], selecting right supply chain [6], customer loyalty [7], understanding customer experience [8] and customer insights [9], competent management [10], superior manufacturing capability [11] and strategies that focus on human capital and R&D for improvement [12], strategic positioning [13], and the right mix of both tangible and intangible resources and creativity [20], just to name a few.

Especially, Japanese companies in the 1970s and 1980s [13], and U.S. companies in the 1980s [12] relied more on operational effectiveness. However, as they benchmark and keep mimicking each other's tools, operational effectiveness would no longer be a key to guaranteeing their competitive advantage. The more they benchmark, the more they resemble each other and blur their identity [13]. Companies' attempt to satisfy the needs of every customer may be good but striving to be all things to all customers almost guarantees nothing and leads to a loss of competitive advantage [13,6]. Porter strongly suggests focusing on strategic positioning to achieve and maintain a competitive advantage [13]. Whereas Sadun et al. [10] argued that managerial practices such as performance monitoring, target setting, talent management, and internal processes as the crucial elements for operational excellence and achieving competitive advantage. However, they underscore managerial practice as a strong complement to a strategy to succeed and commend being both a manager and strategist [10]. Hereby, this paper attempts to define strategy and elucidates the possible basis of strategic positioning and how competitive advantage could be achieved through strategic positioning.

2. DEFINITION OF STRATEGY

Strategy is a widely used term among academics in various fields of study and sectors. Hence, the essence and its application are not limited to business Companies, but also to military, governmental, and non-governmental organizations [13]. Because of its pervasiveness, strategy has been defined and understood from diverse points of view. In the following table, we see some of the definitions of strategy:

Porter, [13]: "Strategy is the creation of a unique and valuable position, involving a different set of activities."

Dawar, [4]: Strategy is a set of activities to create and deliver value to customers while reducing their cost and perceived risk.

Mintzberg, et al. [14] "Strategy refers to how a product sits or fits in the market and locating an organization in what organization theorists call an 'environment'."

Pisano, [2]: "A strategy is a commitment to a set of coherent, mutually reinforcing policies or behaviors aimed at achieving a specific competitive goal."

Moreover, Mintzberg, et al. [14] define strategy in terms of the 5Ps: as a plan that gives direction, a ploy that leads to a specific action, a pattern that indicates consistency in behavior, a position that depicts fit of product and market, a perspective which is engraved as attitudes and norms. Herewith, especially motivated by Porter, [13]; Dawar, [4], and Mintzberg, et al. [14], I define strategy as a distinctive position in which an organization sets up unique activities that enable it to achieve a competitive advantage and its customers to get higher values with a fair price.

3. TYPES OF STRATEGIC POSITIONING

Companies, generally, compete either by operational effectiveness (OE) or strategic positioning, or both [13]. Operational effectiveness means "doing similar activities better than the rivals perform them; whereas strategic positioning means performing different activities from what rivals do or performing similar activities in different ways" [13]. Strategic positioning delimits and forces a company to base on distinct grounds: either serving the few needs of many customers, or serving the broad needs of few customers, or serving the broad needs of many customers in a narrow market [13]. In line with this, Porter introduced three strategic positioning: variety-based strategic positioning, need-based strategic positioning, and access-based strategic positioning. Whereas [14] classified strategic positioning into four overlapping categories: Commodity strategy -targeting a mass market with a single standardized product; segmentation strategy -targeting a segmented market with a range of products; Niche strategy -targets a small isolated market with the delineated product; Customization strategy-includes both niche and segmentation and aligns each product to a certain need of a customer. The variety-based strategy of Porter is most likely like the commodity strategy but not only limited to it. The rest three strategies of Mintzberg et al. [14] can be categorized as either need or access-based strategies of Porter. Thus, this paper addresses the three strategic positioning of Porter [13] and proposes *hybrid strategic positioning* (combination of two or more positioning) as a new position.

3.1 Variety-based Strategic Positioning

This positioning takes its basis on producing a certain subset of an industry's products. It is called variety-based positioning because it stresses types or varieties of products selected for operation and masters on that product or set of products [13], which closely resembles Hayes and Pisano's (2000) idea of focused factories. It requires a company to be the best in producing a product using a distinctive set of activities. Jiffy Lube International, for instance, specializes in automotive lubricants and does not render any other car repair or maintenance service [13]. Porter calls it the 'few needs of many customers.' The type of customer may not really be limited and anyone who wants to get that service can be attracted and make a buying decision, e.g., restaurants offering national dishes and hotels. In many cases, variety-based positioning serves diversified customers, but it only satisfies a subset of their needs [13,14].

In this positioning, a target can be on a mass market with a single standardized product, which is called commodity strategy [14]. A company may have many differentiated products or only one product that significantly varies from the rivals [15,13]. It can also go for differentiation in the same product line to maintain its competitive advantage [15]. Differentiation strategy is the central theme in this positioning and key for competitiveness. And we can say that the need for variety gives birth to differentiation. Southwest Airlines did it using secondary airports, auto-ticketing, fewer aircrafts with frequent departures, fast turnarounds, no meals, no seat arrangement, no commission to agents, no interline luggage checking, and then, finally, achieved low cost [13]. If there is no possibility for differentiation, there would be no variety after all. Meanwhile, if a company loses the ability to differentiate its product, or customers are gaining more bargaining power, a company may go for options like moving downstream, especially in the manufacturing business [5].

Those manufacturing companies relying on upstream activities work more on pruning their product to attain competitive advantage [11]. After all, having a unique product is the key to variety-based strategic positioning to achieve competitive advantage [13]. However, a company should be aware that delivering a great product is not enough to gain a customer's allegiance [5]. Nowadays, it is no longer about having a better or unique product, but customers' needs and purchase criteria of downstream matter most for competitive advantage [4]. He strongly argues that the strategic question in today's business world is not "what else can we make?" but "what else can we do for our customers?" (p102). Moreover, it is the shifting in customers' purchase criteria that derives the pace and evolution of markets rather than improving products or technology [4]. Hence, the continuity of strategic position and sustainability of the advantage has to be ensured by inculcating these issues.

3.2 Need-based Strategic Positioning

It is about positioning a company in a place to serve most or all the needs of a particular group of customers [13]. It gives emphasis on market segmentation and targets a particular segment/s of customers [13]. It can work best when there are bunches of customers with different needs and a distinctive set of activities to serve them. A market analyst should clearly determine the characteristics of each segment [16]. Some of the groups of customers are highly price-sensitive, while others are more interested in the design, features, and quality of the product. IKEA is an iconic example that targets stylish young people offering low-cost self-service in assembly and delivery. And it works to fulfill all the furnishing needs of these customers [13]. To this end, companies may need to adopt flexible manufacturing systems to meet customers' ever-growing needs. For example, Sport Obermeyer, the leading supplier in the U.S. fashion-ski-apparel market, redesigns almost all its products on an annual basis to incorporate changes in style, fabric, and color to retain its customers [21]. Flexible manufacturing enables companies to produce a wide range of goods so that target customers can get exactly what they want [12, 21]. On this basis, the company's primary concern is not to be unique but to meet the diverse needs of its target customers

in a fully packed way. Also, it forces companies to go downstream to meet the unmet needs of their customers [5]. However, it must be noted that companies driven by customer needs sooner or later will lose their product uniqueness.

3.3 Access-based Strategic Positioning

It's part of a segmentation strategy in which customers are segmented based on accessibility for marketing [15,13]. Even though their needs are like those of other customers, the best combination of activities to address them is different [13]. Segmenting customers based on access is less common compared to the other two. It is all about positioning the service or product of a company in a way to address customers in a different geographical set like rural and urban or small and large cities. For example, Carmike Cinemas exclusively operates its movie service in cities and towns with a population below 200,000. It can reach small towns with fewer ticket prices, standardized, small-sized projectors, and low-cost theater complexes [13]. Also, those micro-finance institutions that give financial services, especially to entrepreneurs in rural areas are also using access as the base for strategic positioning. Toyota does not have a clear strategic position, but its basic philosophy is to produce vehicles where customers are (Watanabe, 2007, p78), and that is why it has manufacturing facilities in different locations.

In access-based strategies, the competitive advantage of a company lies in identifying niche or unreached customers and finding the best offline or online/ offshore or onshore means to reach out to them. Another good example is from digital financial service firms with no specific physical address such as WorldRemit and Wise money transfer systems operating online and interconnected with traditional banks for payment. They significantly reduced or avoided financial intermediaries, commission fees, and inflated exchange rates which resulted in low cost of transactions. For example, from personal experience, I have come to know that to transfer 100$ from Hungary to Ethiopia, it takes 8$ as transaction cost and a minimum of 5 days for delivery in a normal bank transfer as of 2021, whereas, with WorldRemit service, charges only 2.15$ for transaction and reaches within maximum 2 days. We see from this that their access-based strategic position enabled them to reduce the lead time and cost of operation and address remote customers who don't have time to visit banks. Correspondence, online education, and webinars are another remarkable example of access-based strategic positioning.

In line with this, online business giants including Alibaba and Tencent of China, Facebook, eBay, Amazon, and Google in the United States mainly give priority to access. They work online and open retail stores in different locations so that they can reach out to customers within a shorter lead time [17]. Most companies use access-based strategic positioning coupling it with the other two strategic positioning. Variety-based and access-based positioning can go together; for instance, in the above case, those online financial firms came up with unique services, that are somewhat different from traditional banks. Also, these two positions do not rely on any customer differences, but, in practice, they always acknowledge differences in needs [13]. Therefore, in this study, I propose a new positioning, which is called *hybrid strategic positioning*.

3.4 Hybrid Strategic Positioning

When a business grows more, there are two most likely scenarios related to its positioning: it can go for a new position by maintaining the existing position, which is called straddling, (e.g., Continental Airline straddled Southwest); or reposition itself by switching from the existing ones (e.g. J.C., Penney repositioned itself from a Sears clone to more fashion-oriented, soft goods retailer) [13]. Specifically, it comes up when a company realizes its need to go for another positioning. For instance, if a company specializes and offers product A in its city outlets (targeting a mass market with a single product) and then if it decides to open retail shops in different rural areas or go online to reach out to remote customers, that shows a mix of variety-based and access-based positioning. Second, if it adds more product lines, and reaches out to different segments of customers like female or male and young or adult, it focuses on the needs or becomes need-based positioning. So, we see the possibility that a company positions itself on a different basis, which we can call *hybrid strategic positioning*. It's becoming common with conglomerates including big retailers: Walmart [18], Alibaba, and Amazon [17] and, even emerging retailers like the Whole Food Markets in USA and SPAR, and TESCO in Europe. After all, a hybrid positioning inclines toward what Porter [13] said 'serving broad needs of broad customers.

4. STRATEGIC POSITIONING AND COMPETITIVE ADVANTAGE

In, relatively, stable business environments where customers' needs are constant, products are durable, competitors are known, and the market is predictable, the competition is all about a "war of position" like securing a playing squarely in a chessboard [19]. In this case, they continued to argue that the key to competitive advantage is *where a company chooses to compete*, not how to compete i.e., is secondary. This amply adds value to the essence of strategic positioning and supplements Porter's argument. Strategic positioning decision is a part of corporate strategy that gives general direction about the overall framework of the operation. In general, the corporate strategy identifies the business a company will pursue, pinpoints new opportunities, and threats in the environment, and sets long-term growth objectives [16]. It also deals with choosing capabilities (i.e., key business processes) that enable one to get a competitive advantage [19]. Besides building capabilities, regardless of the positioning, managers should test resources in terms of inimitability, substitutability, durability, appropriability, and competitive superiority [20]. Perhaps, organizational capabilities and the right mix of resources play a prominent role in securing the competitive advantage [19]. Above all, Sadun, et al. [10] argue that managerial capital is a key factor that makes a persistent difference in firm performance and process quality and achieving operational excellence as well as competitive advantage.

Besides, fitness in the entire system or activities is the key to successful strategic positioning and attaining competitive advantage. Despite the appropriateness of strategic positioning, a competitive advantage can only be attained if there is a fit

[13,14]. Usually, managers get trapped in a growth net [13] or addicted to growing more instantaneously [21]. Their desire to accelerate growth by serving all customers, lowering prices, and differentiating services and products offered finally leads to a loss of strategic position. In this case, as a solution, Porter suggests deepening the company by making it more distinctive, strengthening fit, and communicating the strategy rather than compromising or broadening it [13]. However, Sadun et al. [10] recommend capitalizing on managerial capabilities where a company is efficient and effective in the operation. The strategy does not work without effective core managerial practices such as talent management, setting targets and objectively measuring and monitoring organizational performance [10]. After their empirical work, they come to conclude that managerial practices as strong complements for the strategy to succeed.

Also, successful strategic positioning presumes the right supply chain [13]. The decision on the supply chain should consider the types of a product whether it's functional or innovative [6]. Innovative products have relatively fewer product life cycles and high demand fluctuations, e.g., electronics. Functional products (e.g., food items and clothes) have predictable demand with longer life cycles and need a physically efficient supply chain, whereas innovative products need a responsive supply chain [6]. Offering innovative products in a physically efficient supply chain with lower cost and less lead time is the most challenging but it can also be a source of competitive advantage [13]. But "*the best supply chains aren't just fast and cost-effective. They are also agile (supply quickly) and adaptable, and they ensure that all their companies' interests stay aligned"* [22].

Hence, as we've been seeing, merely relying on strategic positioning is not sufficient to achieve a competitive advantage. A company also needs to properly implement other generic or functional strategies such as innovation strategies [2] and marketing strategies including penetration strategy, image differentiation, support, bundling, market, and product development strategy (targeting new products in the same market) [14,23]. The right strategic positioning needs to have the right functional strategies. For instance, in a need-based strategic positioning, unless the company changes position, a market development strategy that targets the same product in a new market cannot be implemented. For example, the GapKids stores which supply teenagers' casual clothes cannot place this product in the adults' market [16] and that is why Continental Airlines awfully failed to position itself in Southwest Airlines' position [13]. Whereas, with variety-based strategic positioning, unless making a product line extension, a company cannot easily go for a brand-new product development strategy.

Besides, the innovation strategy must create value for customers in the form of making a product perform better, easier to use, more durable, cheaper, reliable, and safer [2,4]. Improvement in innovative activities is continuous action and it needs either upgrading resources -moving beyond what an organization is already good at or leveraging the resources in different ways for different products [20]. The problem with innovation improvement efforts starts from a lack of clear innovation strategy and misalignment of innovation strategies with other strategies [2]. Above all, companies' innovative strategies need to realize the purchase criteria of customers and meet the needs of target customers to ensure

their competitive advantage [4]. For example, Cialis has beaten both Viagra and Levitra with better purchase criteria: efficacy, safety, and duration of 31 hrs. difference.

As Japanese companies did it in the 1970s and 80s [13], manufacturing activities can be the source of competitive advantage [11] if appropriate management tools like Kaizen (Watanabe, 2007), TQM, JIT [28] and others are well implemented to reduce defects and if inventories are well managed [16]. Toyota Company is an iconic example that used Kaizen for continuous improvement and counted remarkable success with operational effectiveness (Wantanabe, 2007). However, this effectiveness nowadays seems to be insufficient. In line with this, Wise and Baumgartner [5] argue that manufacturers need to shift their focus from operational excellence to customer allegiance to maximize downstream value. As competition gets stiff, the source of competitive advantage has shifted from upstream to downstream activities [4]. New business models such as embedded service, comprehensive service, integrated solution, and distribution control, separate or combined, are found to be the keys to competitive advantage [5]. For example, Boeing has broadened its view of the value chain and now offers financing, local parts supply, ground maintenance, logistics management, and pilot training. Hence, companies need to incorporate these services in their business model while setting up any strategic positioning. Fig. 1 presents the integration of strategic positioning, operational effectiveness, and other relevant functional strategies contributing to achieving competitive advantage.

Moreover, competitors and customers have become too unpredictable, and industries too amorphous. The forces at work here are familiar: the digital revolution, a “flat” world, fewer barriers to entry, and globalization. To stay ahead, they need to constantly start new strategic initiatives, building and exploiting many *transient competitive advantages* at once, instead of sticking to the same old playbook [24]. However, most companies cannot quickly change their business model to open new revenue streams. Different firm activities are interlocked with one another via standard procedures. There’s a high cost to switching internal operations [25-28].

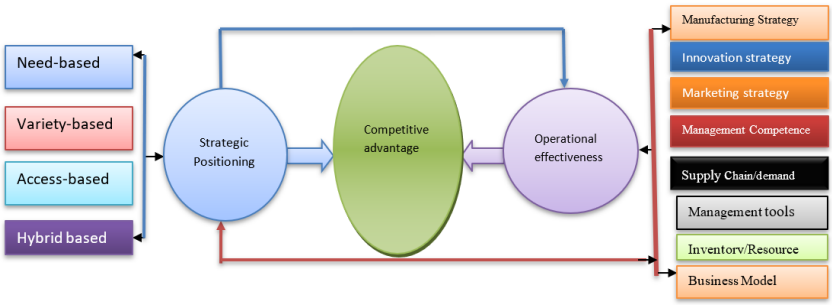

Fig. 1. Conceptual Framework of strategic positioning and competitive advantage
Source: Own creation, 2019

5. CONCLUSION

Especially in a relatively predictable market, as the competition takes the form of a *"war of position",* a key to competitive advantage is where a company chooses to compete. This idea augments the importance of Porter's argument on strategic positioning in achieving competitive advantage. Therefore, as illustrated in Fig, 1:
- First, strategy as a position must be well understood and the proper basis for strategic positioning must be laid down. As we discussed above in the case of companies like IKEA furniture, Southwestern Airlines, and Neutrogena corporation that opt to sell their soaps in drug stores rather than ordinary shops, strategic positioning itself could be a source of competitive advantage. However, it does not mean that a company no longer needs operational effectiveness to compete. Also, it is unworthy to compare the contribution of strategic positioning and operational competitiveness which is normally measured in terms of cost, quality, lead time, and flexibility; because once a company comes to know its right strategic positioning, it is not an option but compulsory to improve operational effectiveness if the company wants to sustain competitive advantage. Also, as thoroughly discussed by Sadun et al (2017) [10], neither pioneer leadership nor brilliant strategy matters without operational effectiveness that comes from good managerial practices.

Moreover, it is found that investing in managerial capital is a key to operational excellence, and better-managed firms are found to be growing faster, more profitable, and less likely to dissolve. Hence, it should be noted that operational excellence is a strong complement to strategy, not as a substitute. In addition to selecting proper strategic positioning, to improve operational effectiveness and ensure the sustainability of its competitive advantage, a company may need to apply management tools like Kaizen and TQM, select the right supply chains, extend embedded & and comprehensive services and integrative solutions and, of course, use the right mix of resources. Second, strategy as a position must be clearly distinguished from other functional or generic strategies. All the functional strategies such as the innovation strategy that creates value for customers and the company, a manufacturing strategy that focuses on unique skills and capabilities, and continually seeks to differentiate itself from rivals, and marketing strategies are required to achieve as well as sustain competitive advantage as they all contribute to the effectiveness of the operation.

COMPETING INTERESTS

The author has declared that no competing interests exist.

REFERENCES

1. Porter ME. Competitive advantage creating and sustaining superior performance. The Free Press; 1985.
2. Pisano G. You need an innovation strategy. Harv Bus Rev. 2015;44-54.
3. Christensen et al. One more time: what is disruptive innovation? Harv Bus Rev. 2015;44-53.

4. Dawar N. When marketing is strategy. Harv Bus Rev; 2013.
5. Wise R, Baumgartner P. Go downstream: The new imperative in manufacturing. Harv Bus Rev. 1999;77:133-41.
6. Fisher ML. What is the right supply chain for your product? Harv Bus Rev, March. 1997;105-16.
7. Lafley AG, Martin RL. Customer loyalty is overrated. Harv Bus Rev. 2017;46-53.
8. Bate AF, Ayman B. Social media as effective tool for understanding customer experience: A systematized review. Hung J Mark Manag. 2021;55(4):15-25.
DOI: 10.15170/mm.2021.55.04.02
9. Ian K, Paul L, Mahadeva M. How to gain a competitive advantage on customer insights. Harvard business review [online]; 2022 [cited Sep 23 2023].
Available:https://hbr.org/2022/10/how-to-gain-a-competitive-advantage-on-customer-insights
10. Sadun R, Bloom N, van Reenen J. Why do we undervalue competent management? HBR, Sep-Oct. 2017;121-7.
11. Wheelwright SC, Hayes RH. Competing through manufacturing. Harv Bus Rev. 1985;99-108.
12. Hayes RH, Pisano G, P. Beyond world-class: the new manufacturing strategy. Harv Bus Rev. 1994;1994:77-86.
13. Porter M. What is strategy. Harv Bus Rev. 1996;61-7.
14. Mintzberg H, Quinn JB, Ghoshal S. The strategy Process, revised European Edition, Prentice Hall. Europe; 1999.
15. Porter ME. Competitive strategy: Techniques for analyzing industries and competitors. New York: The Free Press; 1980.
16. Krajeweskhi LJ, Ritzman LP, Malhotra MK. Operations management. 10th ed. England: Prentice Hall, Pearson Education Limited; 2013.
17. Zeng M. Ali Baba and the future of business. Harv Bus Rev. 2018;88-96.
18. Johnson F. The supply chain management at Wal-Mart, Ivey management services. London: University of Western Ontario; 2008.
19. Stalk G, Evans P, Shulman LE. Competing on capabilities: The new rules of corporate strategy. Harv Bus Rev. 1992;70(2):57-69. PMID 10117369.
20. Collis DJ, Montgomery CA. Competing on Resources: Strategy in the 1990s. Harv Bus Rev. 1995;73(4):118-28.
21. Fisher M, Gaur V, Kleinberger H. Curing the addiction to growth. Harv Bus Rev. 2017;66-74.
22. Lee HL. The triple-A supply chain, Harvard business review, reprint. 2004;R0410F; On Point 8096.
23. Bate AF. The effect of market orientation and entrepreneurial orientation on new product development. Hung J Mark Manag. 2019;53(2):45-53.
DOI: 10.15170/MM.2019.53.02.04
24. Rita M. Transient advantage. Harvard business review [online]; 2013 [cited Sep 23 2023].
Available:https://hbr.org/2013/06/transient-advantage
25. Mark G, Howard Y. In a crisis, ecosystem businesses have a competitive advantage. Harvard business review [online]; 2020 [cited Sep 23 2023].

Available:https://hbr.org/2020/04/in-a-crisis-ecosystem-businesses-have-a-competitive-advantage.

26. D'Aveni RA. The 3-D printing playbook, Business model for additive manufacturing. Harv Bus Rev. 2018;106-14.
27. Hendricks KB, Singhal VR. Does implementing an effective TQM program actually improve operating performance? Manag Sci. 1997;1997:1258-75.
28. Sakakibara S, Flynn BB, Schroeder RG, Morris WT. The impact of just- in-time manufacturing and its infrastructure on manufacturing performance. Manag Sci. 1997;43(9):1246-57.
DOI: 10.1287/mnsc.43.9.1246

Biography of author(s)

Adisu Fanta Bate
University of Pecs, Hungary.

He has completed his Ph.D. at the Doctoral School of Business Administration, Faculty of Business and Economics, University of Pecs, Hungary. He served as an assistant professor at the Faculty of Business and Economics, Wolaita Sodo University, Ethiopia, since 2016. Previously, he was a lecturer at the Department of Management, Madawalabu University, Ethiopia, from 2009 to 2015. His teaching courses and research interests are related to Business Management, Entrepreneurial Economics, and Financial Management. He has published 18 research papers in international peer-reviewed journals and conference proceedings: https://www.researchgate.net/profile/Adisu-Fanta-2. He has completed his Master of Business Administration and Master of Public Administration at Andhra University, India, and his bachelor's degree in management from Mekelle University, Ethiopia, and Ph.D. in Business Administration at the University of Pecs, Hungary, Europe. His Ph.D. dissertation focuses on the entrepreneurial orientation of small and medium enterprises in developing countries.

© Copyright (2023): Author(s). The licensee is the publisher (B P International).

Peer Review History:
This chapter was reviewed by following the Advanced Open Peer Review policy. This chapter was thoroughly checked to prevent plagiarism. As per editorial policy, a minimum of two peer-reviewers reviewed the manuscript. After review and revision of the manuscript, the Book Editor approved the manuscript for final publication. Peer review comments, comments of the editor(s), etc. are available here: https://peerreviewarchive.com/review-history/6522C